ORACC SAAo saa09: the Assyrian prophecies (SAA 9, Parpola 1997), all 11 texts

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Usefulness 6

- **Texts:** the eleven Neo-Assyrian prophecy tablets from Nineveh (Kuyunjik), reigns of Esarhaddon (681–669 BCE) and Assurbanipal (668–c. 631):

File prefix	SAA 9	Museum no. (P-number)	Title (Parpola)	Prophets named	Lines
SAA09-001--P333952	1	K 4310 (4 R² 61) (P333952)	Oracles of Encouragement to Esarhaddon (a collection of ten oracles, 1.1–1.10)	Issar-la-tašiyaṭ, Sinqiša-amur, Remutti-Allati, Bayâ, Ilussa-amur, Issar-beli-da”ini, Aḫat-abiša, La-dagil-ili	214
SAA09-002--P337152	2	K 12033 + 82-5-22,527 (P337152)	Oracles Concerning Babylon and the Stabilization of the King's Rule (2.1–2.6)	Nabû-ḫussanni, Bayâ, La-dagil-ili, Urkittu-šarrat	144
SAA09-003--P334927	3	K 2401 (ABRT 1 22–23) (P334927)	The Covenant of Aššur (3.1–3.5)	La-dagil-ili	145
SAA09-004--P336677	4	83-1-18,839 (P336677)	Fragment of a Collection of Encouragement Oracles	–	9
SAA09-005--P337153	5	K 6259 (P337153)	An Oracle to the Queen Mother	–	17
SAA09-006--P336678	6	Bu 91-5-9,106 + 109 (P336678)	An Oracle from Tašmetu-ereš of Arbela	Tašmetu-ereš	22
SAA09-007--P334928	7	K 883 (ABRT 1 26–27) (P334928)	Prophecies for Crown Prince Assurbanipal	Mullissu-kabtat	25
SAA09-008--P334828	8	K 1545 (ABL 1280) (P334828)	Words Concerning the Elamites	–	11
SAA09-009--P337163	9	K 1292 + DT 130 (P337163)	Words of Encouragement to Assurbanipal (dated Nisan 18, eponymy of Bēl-šaddûa, 650 BCE)	Dunnaša-amur	35
SAA09-010--P314355	10	83-1-18,726 (CT 53 946) (P314355)	Fragment of a Prophecy	Dunnaša-amur	17

File prefix	SAA 9	Museum no. (P-number)	Title (Parpola)	Prophets named	Lines
`SAA09-011--P313634`	11	K 1974 (CT 53 219) (P313634)	Report on a Vision and an Oracle to Assurbanipal	–	13

(Museum numbers and first publications from the ORACC catalogue, `catalogue.json` in the zip.) 652 tablet lines in all.

- **Editor:** Simo Parpola, *Assyrian Prophecies* (State Archives of Assyria 9), Helsinki 1997. Lemmatised by Mikko Luukko (2012), AHRC project "Mechanisms of Communication in an Ancient Empire" (UCL, dir. K. Radner).
- **URLs:** per text `https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/saao/saa09/<P-number>` (HTML view with Parpola's translation: append `/html`); data: `https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/json/saao-saa09.zip` (773 KB; JSON export 2024-06-10), kept as `../_bulk/saao-saa09.zip` (gitignored; `tools/sources_sync.py` has a built-in rule for ORACC zips). ORACC needs the certificate workaround of `tools/certs/` (2026-10-21).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-21.
- **Licence:** zip metadata "CC0"; the per-text credits: "The annotated edition is released under the **Creative Commons Attribution Share-Alike license 3.0**". Treated as **CC BY-SA 3.0**, committed with this attribution. Cite as `http://oracc.org/saao/<P-number>/`.

Files

File	What	Committed?
`SAA09-NNN--<P>--lemmatised.md`	Per line: label (ORACC: `o i 1'` = obverse, column i, line 1′), transliteration, **`norm:`** (the SAAo normalization, word by word; `—` = none) and `lem:` (citation form[guide word=contextual sense]POS). Converted with `../../../tools/cdl2md.py ../_bulk/saao-saa09.zip saao/saa09/corpusjson/<P>.json <out> <title> <url> --norm`. Lines that are wholly broken have a label and no `norm:`.	yes
`SAA09-NNN--<P>--translation.md`	Parpola's English (as adapted in SAAo), one paragraph per unit, labelled with the first transliteration line it covers; rulings marked. Extracted with `../../../tools/oracc_html2tr.py`. **Rank 3: consult only after our own reading.**	yes (CC BY-SA, attributed)
`SAA09-NNN--<P>--oracc-view.html`	the raw HTML views (20–290 KB).	**no** (this folder's `.gitignore`; re-download: `curl --cacert <(cat "$SSL_CERT_FILE" ../../../tools/certs/*.pem) -o … https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/saao/saa09/<P>/html`)

Line numbering

ORACC = SAA 9 = Parpola 1997: surface (o / r / b.e. / t.e. / l.e.), column (roman, in the multi-column tablets 1–3), line; primes (′) mark lines counted from a break. The literature cites the oracles both by line (SAA 9 1 ii 16′) and by Parpola's oracle numbers (**1.4**, **2.5**, **3.3** …), which are not in the data: the oracle units are marked by the rulings and the colophon formula *ša pî* / *issu pî* PN "by the mouth of PN". Our project files mark them as section headings (`## 1.1` …, see `נבואה-ומלכות/1-נבואות-אשוריות/project.md`). The literature after 1997 (Nissinen's *Prophets and Prophecy in the Ancient Near East*, SBL Writings from the Ancient World 12, and its later edition; Weippert's studies of the oracles) uses the same oracle numbers (from memory, not checked here: no copy obtained; © SBL).

Usefulness

Rank 1 base text for `/נבואה-ומלכות/1-נבואות-אשוריות`. The only corpus of written prophecy from the ancient Near East outside the Bible (with the Mari letters, OB, which are a separate corpus); contemporary with Isaiah and Micah, and the closest formal parallel to the salvation oracle ("fear not … I am …", Isa 41:8–13; Gen 15:1; 26:24). Text 1 is well preserved; texts 2 and 3 are broken at column edges; 4–6, 10–11 are fragments. The `norm:` line gives the editors' normalization of every preserved word; about a third of the words in texts 2–6 are unlemmatised (`u`, broken).